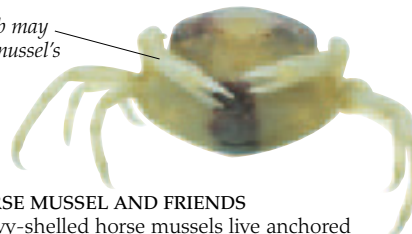


LONG LEGS

Spider crabs all have long legs and look like spiders. They hide under rocks and among seaweeds on the lower shore and in shallow waters. Spider crabs make a camouflage by plucking bits of seaweed with their pincers, then attaching these bits to their shells. They crawl over seaweeds hanging on with their claws. Spider crabs can also live on soft seabeds.

Pea crab may nibble mussel's gills



Seaweeds growing on mussel shell



HORSE MUSSEL AND FRIENDS

Heavy-shelled horse mussels live anchored to rocks or kelp holdfasts in shallow water, attached by tough threads. Young mussels settle where another mussel is growing, so gradually a mussel layer builds up on the seabed. Other creatures live among mussels, but the pea crab takes things a stage further. It makes its home within the shell, feeding on the mussel's food.

Seaweed on legs as part of camouflage

Sharp-tipped claw for hanging onto seaweed

Horse mussel grows to 8 in (20 cm) long

Feathery tentacles held on tough, single stems

Anemonelike polyp with two rings of tentacles to capture food

SEA FLOWERS

The beautiful flowerlike polyps of this sea fir (hydroid) are used to capture food. If disturbed, the sea fir will withdraw its polyps into its horny skeleton. Sea firs grow fixed to surfaces, such as rocks and seaweeds, putting out branched colonies of anemonelike polyps. Some sea firs reproduce by budding off tiny jellyfish forms, which shed sperm and eggs into the water. The young sea fir then settles on the bottom. This sea fir (right) does not produce such free-floating shapes. Instead, the jellyfish forms stay attached to the parent sea fir which then releases its young.

Sea mat growing on surface

